

Nonprofit and NGO English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: nonprofit program managers, NGO staff, grant writers, development officers, monitoring and evaluation teams, field coordinators, volunteer managers, and nonprofit executives

Focus: A nonprofit and NGO English curriculum for donor communication, grants, program evaluation, field operations, safeguarding, community partnerships, volunteer management, and mission-versus-budget tradeoffs.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design

Setting

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Speaker	Line
Program director	Use inspirational stories only.
Donor	Inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm mission, theory of change, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Program director	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short theory-of-change explanation. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: mission, theory of change.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects theory of change.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	mission
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use inspirational stories only.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify mission and theory of change against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve mission after the result is visible.
C	A theory-of-change explanation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A donor asks how activities create outcomes. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the theory-of-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions

Setting

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Speaker	Line
Development director	Accept it because funding is scarce.
Executive director	Mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm restricted funding, deliverable, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Development director	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short grant-fit recommendation. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: restricted funding, deliverable.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects deliverable.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	restricted funding

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Accept it because funding is scarce.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify restricted funding and deliverable against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	A grant-fit recommendation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A funder offers money for work outside the mission. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the grant-fit recommendation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning

Setting

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Speaker	Line
M&E specialist	Call the program successful.
Program manager	Indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm indicator, baseline, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
M&E specialist	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short evaluation caveat paragraph. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: indicator, baseline.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects baseline.

Option	Phrase
A	attribution
B	learning agenda
C	indicator
D	baseline

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Call the program successful.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify indicator and baseline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve indicator after the result is visible.
D	A evaluation caveat paragraph is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the evaluation caveat paragraph with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Field Operations and Partner Coordination

Setting

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Speaker	Line
Field coordinator	Pressure the partner publicly.
Partner organization	Local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm implementing partner, field visit, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Field coordinator	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short partner recovery plan. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: implementing partner, field visit.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice**1. Complete the field language**

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects field visit.

Option	Phrase
A	field visit
B	contingency
C	community trust
D	implementing partner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Pressure the partner publicly.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify implementing partner and field visit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. Safeguarding and Incident Reporting

Setting

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Speaker	Line
Safeguarding lead	Ask the staff member informally.
Volunteer manager	Safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm safeguarding, confidentiality, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Safeguarding lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short safeguarding intake note. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: safeguarding, confidentiality.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects confidentiality.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	safeguarding
C	incident report
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask the staff member informally.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify safeguarding and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safeguarding intake note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. Volunteer Management and Training

Setting

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Speaker	Line
Volunteer coordinator	Let them help wherever needed.
Volunteer	Role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm volunteer role, training, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Volunteer coordinator	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short volunteer boundary script. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: volunteer role, training.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects training.

Option	Phrase
A	supervision
B	duty of care
C	volunteer role
D	training

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Let them help wherever needed.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify volunteer role and training against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the volunteer boundary script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality

Setting

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Speaker	Line
Communications manager	Use it because it gets attention.

Speaker	Line
Campaign lead	Source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm advocacy, campaign, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Communications manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short advocacy message review. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: advocacy, campaign.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects campaign.

Option	Phrase
A	source
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	advocacy

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use it because it gets attention.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A advocacy message review is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify advocacy and campaign against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve advocacy after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the advocacy message review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. Board Reporting and Sustainability

Setting

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Speaker	Line
Executive director	Ask the board for emergency funds without options.
Board treasurer	Scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm board governance, cash runway, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Executive director	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short board sustainability update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: board governance, cash runway.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cash runway.

Option	Phrase
A	scenario
B	evidence threshold
C	board governance
D	reserve

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask the board for emergency funds without options.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify board governance and cash runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve board governance after the result is visible.
C	A board sustainability update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Cash runway is tightening while demand rises. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the board sustainability update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. mission	'mission' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify mission and theory of change against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the theory-of-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. restricted funding	'restricted funding' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify restricted funding and deliverable against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the grant-fit recommendation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. indicator	'indicator' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify indicator and baseline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the evaluation caveat paragraph with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. implementing partner	'implementing partner' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify implementing partner and field visit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. safeguarding	'safeguarding' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify safeguarding and confidentiality against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safeguarding intake note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Volunteer Management and Training - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. volunteer role	'volunteer role' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Volunteer Management and Training - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify volunteer role and training against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Volunteer Management and Training - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the volunteer boundary script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. advocacy	'advocacy' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify advocacy and campaign against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the advocacy message review with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. board governance	'board governance' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify board governance and cash runway against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Board Reporting and Sustainability - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the board sustainability update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.